

NSHD OWL

Data Coverage Report

What is currently available on OWL and the NSHD Showcase — and what is still to come.

28,898 Variables on OWL	~6,102 Still to be cleaned (Condor only)	83% Metadata enhancement complete
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rmjdish.github.io/OWL/docs/data-coverage/

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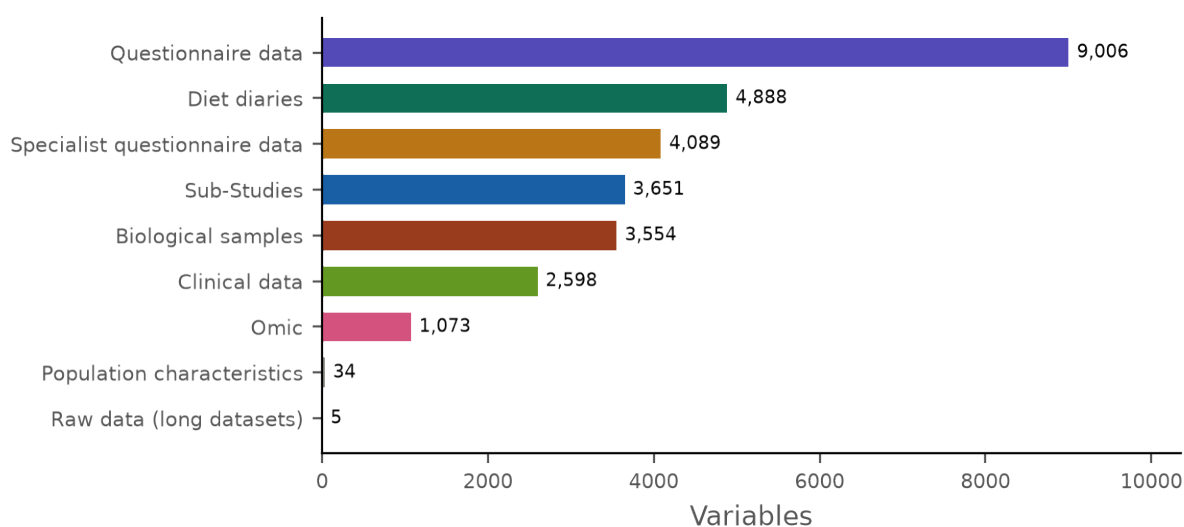
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What is currently available

OWL and the NSHD Showcase currently provide access to around **28,898 variables** — those cleaned and enhanced as part of the Metadata Enhancement Project. The full NSHD repository contains approximately 35,000+ variables; the remaining ~6,102 are available on Condor. The 28,898 variables shown here cover 43 collection years spanning 1946 to 2025, across 9 topic areas and 50+ data collection forms.

Variables by topic area

Variables are organised into 9 top-level topic areas, shown largest to smallest. Questionnaire data (9,006) and Diet diaries (4,888) make up the largest share.



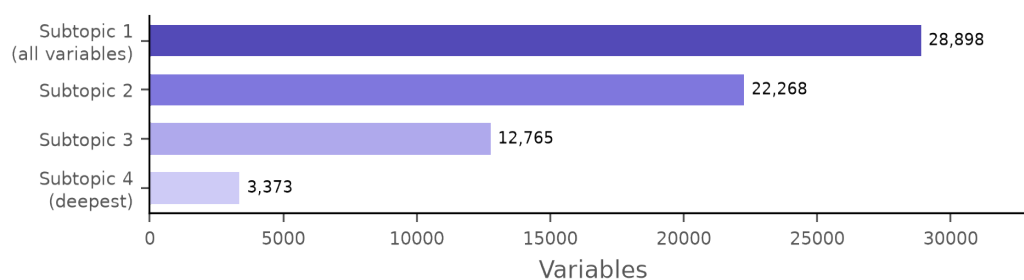
Topic coverage by collection year

Which topic areas were covered in each major data collection sweep. Darker cells indicate more variables collected for that topic in that sweep. Population characteristics and Raw data are omitted as their counts are low across every sweep.

1946 –	3					12	
1948 –	5					13	
1950 –	10	152				13	
1952 –	21					13	
1953 –	10					15	
1954 –						9	
1955 –	3						
1956 –	2						
1957 –	18					29	
1959 –	13						
1961 –	42					27	
1962 –	6						
1965 –	7						
1966 –	15					15	
1968 –	6						
1969 –	1						
1971 –	14						
1972 –	92					22	
1977 –	214						
1982 –	1,115	1,181				36	
1989 –	1,335	1,181				162	
1993 –			232				
1994 –			258				
1995 –			265				
1996 –			272				
1997 –			400				
1998 –			333				
1999 –	1,211	1,047	326		31	346	1,066
2000 –			504				
2003 –			182				
2005 –			44				
2006-10 –	2,375	1,327	141		3,255	1,476	3
2014 –	726						
2015 –	754			3	250	181	
2015-2018 –				935			
2018-2021 –				1,856			4
2020 –	6		648				
2020-2024 –				857			
2021 –	4		409				
2022 –	513						
2023 –	240		75		18	229	
2025 –	243						
Questionnaire data		Diet diaries		Specialist questionnaire data		Sub-Studies	
				Biological samples		Clinical data	
						Omic	

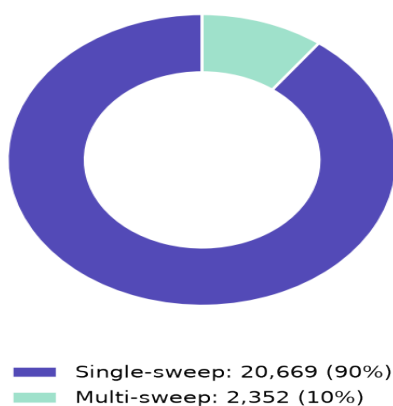
Category classification depth

All 28,898 variables have at least one subtopic level. Deeper classification indicates a more precisely placed variable in the Browse by Category hierarchy.



Single-sweep vs multi-sweep Field IDs

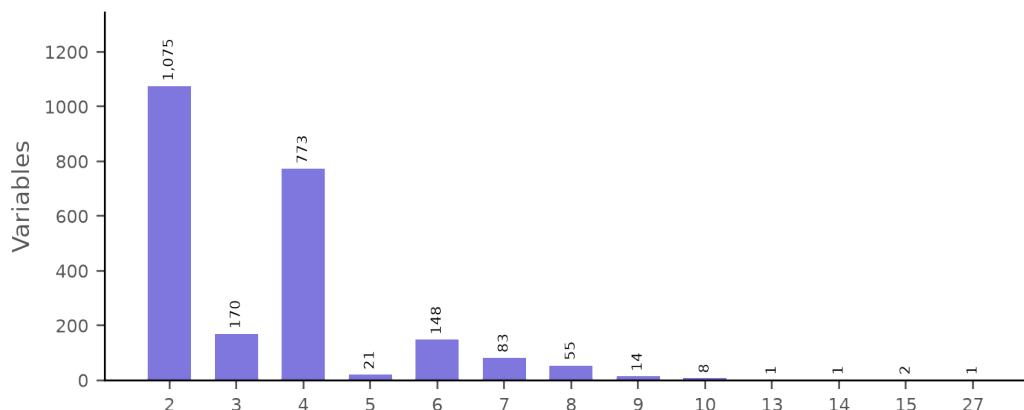
Of the 23,021 unique Showcase Field IDs, 10% were collected at more than one time point with identical question text and coding.



Note: this chart groups sweeps by distinct collection year per Field ID. A small number of Field IDs were collected more than once within the same labelled year (e.g. Covid wave 1 and wave 2, both recorded as 2020) and are counted here as single-sweep.

Longitudinal tracking depth

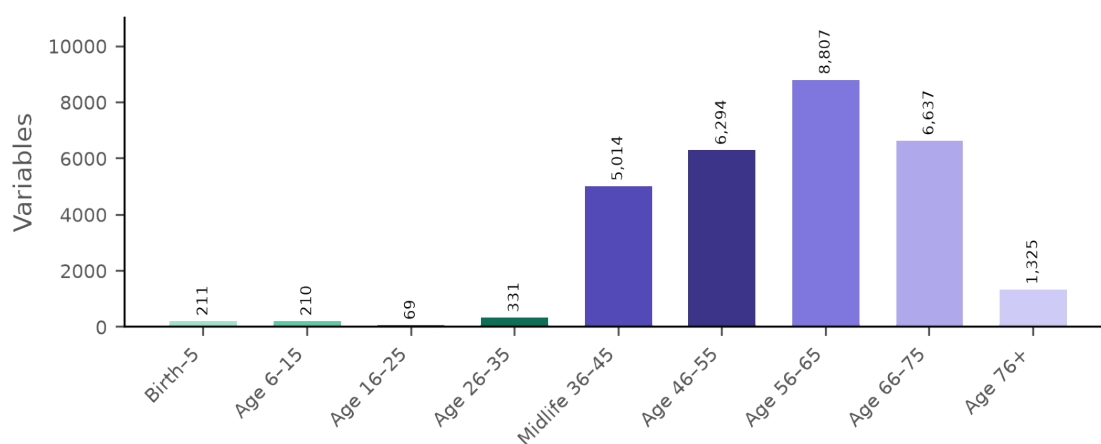
Of 23,021 unique Showcase Field IDs, 2,352 (10%) have been collected at more than one sweep, some for decades. The most consistently tracked variable is **Interview contact status (recoded) at age 19** (Field ID 6200), collected across 27 sweeps spanning 77 years.



Note: these counts only include truly longitudinal variables — those collected with identical question text and coding at every sweep they appear in. Re-worded or re-coded repeats of a question get a separate Field ID and are not counted as a repeat sweep here.

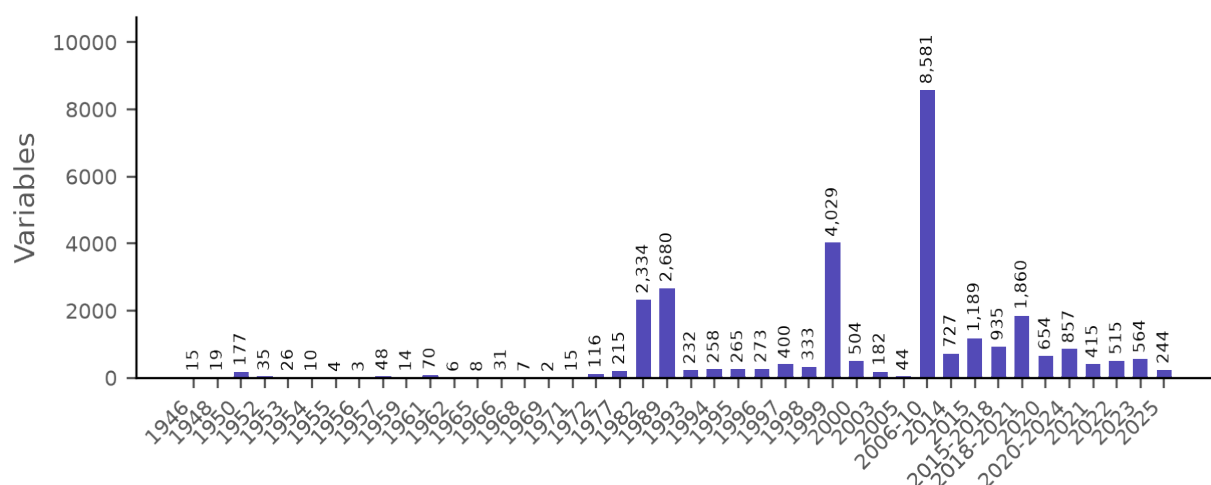
Variables by life stage

The volume of variables reflects the intensity of data collection at each phase of life. The richest coverage is at ages 56–65, corresponding to the major 2006–2010 clinic visit.



Variables by collection year

Variable counts for each collection year or period. The dominant peaks reflect the major intensive data collection sweeps — 2006-10 (8,581), 1999 (4,029), 1989 (2,680), 1982 (2,334).



Variables by data collection form

Variables come from a wide range of data collection instruments, shown largest to smallest ("Other forms" is a catch-all bucket and is always listed last).

Form	Variables
Diet diaries	4,901
Postal questionnaire	4,745
Nurse Clinic/Home visit	3,573
Blood / Urine / Saliva assays	3,565
Women's Health Questionnaire	2,800
Insight 46 (phases 1 & 2)	2,590
Imaging and devices (Ultrasound, Dicom, Actiheart monitor etc)	1,513
DNA / Genomics	1,071
Covid questionnaires	1,064
Self-completion booklet	867
Myofit sub-study	817
Cognitive tests	165
Doctor's examination	92
Mother's Interview	78
Teacher's questionnaire	19
Other forms	1,038

Note: this table groups variables by the instrument used to collect them (Form), which can differ from their category classification (Subtopic). 40 variables categorised under the Myofit study were collected using another instrument (37 via ACEIII questionnaire; 3 via Blood assays) and are counted under that instrument's row above rather than under "Myofit sub-study". 204 variables categorised under the Insight46 study were collected using another instrument (201 via Ultrasound; 3 via Blood assays) and are counted under that instrument's row above rather than under "Insight 46 (phases 1 & 2)".

UKLLC harmonised datasets

2,865 variables (9.9% of the 28,898 on OWL) have been standardised into a harmonised dataset for cross-cohort comparison via the UK Longitudinal Linkage Collaboration (UKLLC), across 16 distinct harmonised datasets.

Harmonised dataset	Variables
Diet (EPIC food frequency questionnaire)	566
Employment history	483
Household composition	381
Heart and circulatory health	378
Blood biochemistry	198
Respiratory health	133
Endocrine and metabolic health	125
Blood pressure	120
Economic circumstances	120
Smoking history	120
Anthropometry (height, weight, body composition)	89
Alcohol consumption	73
Clinical disorders	52
Cancer diagnoses	29
Education history	22
APOE genotype	6